

(WO)MEN'S WEAR

INDIAN MENSWEAR is mostly fashioned around the idea of 'the complete man'. Between the very regal *bandhgalas*, the ornate *sherwanis* and the corporate sharp suits are the liminal spaces where even the complete man wants to put his hair down and party—wearing exuberance and not excess. Arguably the best outfits for that come from Rimzim Dadu, one of the edgiest Indian designers, known for her sculptural silhouettes created with unusually made textiles. Reputed for her women's wear, Dadu has expressed her very powerful design language of unique textures and vivid metallic patinas, created by joining hair-thin (0.45 micron) steel wires, fusing it with conventional menswear like shirts, tuxedos, formal suits, and bomber jackets with remarkable restraint. The resultant silhouettes are sharp and formal, yet express her core design idiom of "restrained maximalism". It is "glamour with fun", she explains. Hailing her groundbreaking fashion, stylist Rahul Vijay describes it as, "Menswear created by a distinct female gaze: One that makes the garments nonconformist, and the men, desirable." It is menswear a woman would want her man in, like this *asymmetric metal bandhgala with pants*, priced at ₹1.51 lakh.